

HANG SHELVES, PHOTOS & TV MOUNTS

The Essential Guide to Secure Wall Mounting

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Introduction

One of the most rewarding ways to make a house feel like a home is to put things on the walls. Whether it's a gallery of family photos, functional shelves, or a sleek wall-mounted TV, taking things off the floor opens up your space and adds personality.

This guide is designed for the absolute beginner. You'll learn how to identify your wall type, choose the right hardware, and mount anything securely—even if you've never used a drill before.

Wall Anatomy

Before you drill, know what you're hitting:

- **Drywall:** Standard in modern homes. Soft, compressed gypsum. Requires anchors for any weight.
- **Masonry:** Brick or concrete. Requires a masonry drill bit and plastic sleeves.
- **Studs:** The wooden frame of the wall. **Mounting to a stud is the gold standard for heavy items.**

The Tool Kit

Power Drill
Bubble Level
Stud Finder
Measuring Tape
Hammer
Painter's Tape

Anchors Away!

If you can't hit a stud, use the right anchor for the job:

Anchor Type	Best For...	Weight Capacity
Plastic Expansion	Light photos/frames	Up to 10 lbs
Self-Drilling	Small shelves/mirrors	Up to 30 lbs
Toggle Bolt	Floating shelves/TVs	50+ lbs

Pro Tip: When drilling into tile, put a piece of painter's tape over the spot to prevent the drill bit from slipping and scratching the tile surface.

Mounting Specific Items

TV Wall Mounts

1. **Find Two Studs:** Heavy TV mounts must be anchored into wooden studs.
2. **Height Check:** Your eyes should be level with the bottom third of the screen when sitting down.
3. **Bolt It In:** Use the heavy lag bolts provided with the mount.

| Patching Mistakes

Drilled a hole in the wrong spot? Don't panic.

- **Small Holes:** Use a tiny dab of white spackle on your finger. Wipe flush with a damp rag.
- **Medium Holes:** Apply spackle with a putty knife, let dry, and sand lightly.